# How the orders service serves a read

A read of one order, `GET /orders/42`, is answered from Redis when it can be and from Postgres when it cannot. This note shows the path, what a miss costs, and where the time goes.

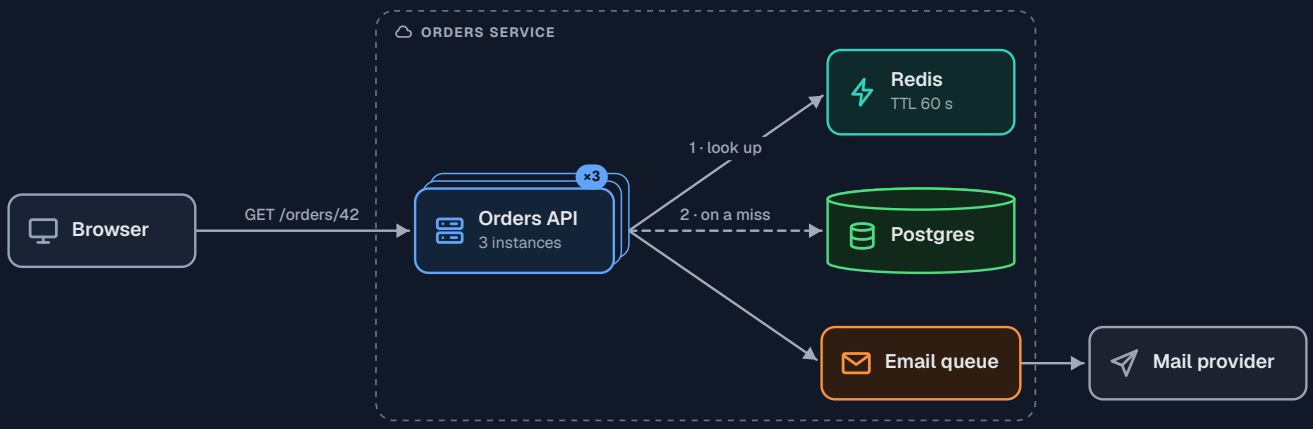


Figure 1: Three API instances behind one address; Postgres only on a miss (the dashed arrow).

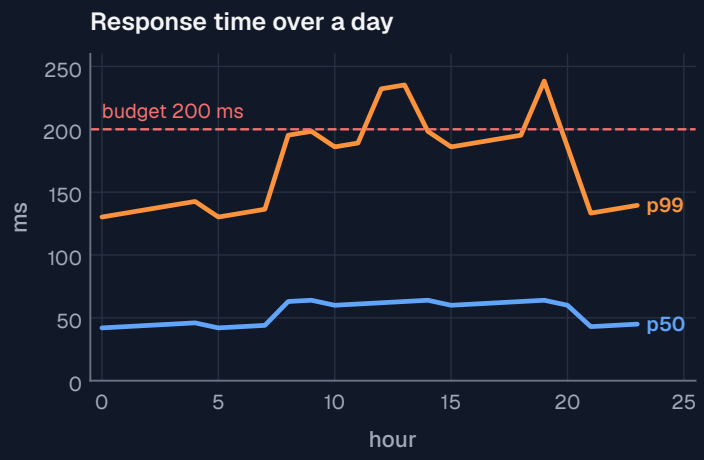


Figure 2: p99 crosses the budget three times a day.

> **Key idea**
> A miss is a slower read, not an error: the API fills the cache on its way back.

| Read | p50 | p99 |
|---|---|---|
| Hit | 9 ms | 13 ms |
| Miss | 41 ms | 48 ms |

```python
def get_order(order_id: int) -> Order:
    cached = redis.get(f"order:{order_id}")
    if cached is not None:              # a hit: 13 ms at p99
        return Order.parse(cached)
    return db.fetch_order(order_id)     # a miss: Postgres
```